the sanctions. Any Member State may submit to the 1267 Committee listing requests for individuals or entities. Such requests must be supported by specific findings and reasoning that the listing criteria are met. It is a well-set procedure. [1] It is, however, anything but transparent.

The heinous terrorist attack by the Lashkar-e-Tayyiba (LeT) in Mumbai on 26 November 2008, in which several foreign nationals were also murdered or injured, drew the world's attention to the long-standing demand of India for the international community to take notice of Pakistan-based groups. One interesting but little known fact is that during the Mumbai terrorist attack, Pakistani handlers had given explicit instructions to kill a Chinese citizen when the terrorists sought instructions, and yet China remained hesitant to call out the Pakistanis because of their strategic alliance. [2] By that time, a number of other prominent terrorists involved in attacks on Western interests or citizens were discovered inside Pakistan, and the Americans may have also suspected that Osama Bin Laden and other Al-Qaida operatives may have been sheltering there. In December 2008, three major LeT operatives who were involved in the Mumbai attacks—Zaki-ur-Rahman Lakhvi, Hafiz Saeed and Haji Muhammed Ashraf—were listed by the 1267 Committee. The listing did not, however, contain a reference to the attack on Mumbai. The listing of the three individuals was a consequence of the association that LeT had kept with Al-Qaida. Nonetheless, it was a positive sign that entities and individuals based in Pakistan who had trained their sights on India, were being sanctioned. It was in such circumstances that India decided to apply to the 1267 Sanctions Committee to proscribe Masood Azhar, the mastermind of the attack on Parliament.

The Permanent Representative (Ambassador) of India to the United Nations, Nirupam Sen, wrote in March 2009 to the 1267